

Bylaws of the EvalEval Coalition

September 2026

1. Purpose and Standing

The EvalEval Coalition brings together researchers and practitioners working on the methodology, infrastructure, and public understanding of AI evaluation, including the assessment of social impact. It pursues work through collaborative projects, shared infrastructure, publications, events, and engagement with policy and standards processes.

The Coalition is a collaborative body and is not separately incorporated, so it relies on voluntary contributions and grants from 501(c)(3) philanthropic and scientific organizations as approved by the Steering Committee for the handling of funds. Everyone who takes part does so in an individual capacity, although institutions may contribute as organizations when named as formal partners for specific projects. Participation commits no one's employer to anything and should not be read as an institutional endorsement.

2. Founding Organizations

The organizations that hosted and incubated the Coalition before these bylaws were adopted: **EleutherAI (represented by Stella Biderman), Hugging Face (represented by Avijit Ghosh and Irene Solaiman), and the University of Edinburgh (represented by Zeerak Talat)**, are recognized as Founding Organizations. That recognition is permanent and appears in Coalition materials, but it carries no governance role, vote, or claim on Coalition resources.

The responsibilities those hosts carried pass to the Steering Committee on the day these bylaws take effect, subject to the Joint Body and Chair ratification requirements under Voting. Fiscal hosting and infrastructure arrangements already in place continue on their existing terms until changed in accordance with these bylaws.

3. Founding Chairs

The individuals who served as Chairs of the Coalition prior to the adoption of these bylaws: **Mubashara Akhtar, Subho Majumdar, Patricia Paskov, Anka Reuel, Jan Batzner, Leshem Choshen, Usman Gohar, Kevin Klyman, Jennifer Mickel, Ichhya Pant, Kevin Wei, Prajna Soni, Wm. Matthew Kennedy, and Michelle Lin**, are recognized as Founding Chairs. This recognition is permanent and may appear in Coalition materials, but carries no continuing governance role, vote, or claim on Coalition resources.

4. Responsibilities and Decision Making

The Coalition divides responsibility among the Steering Committee, Chairs, and Project Leads. These responsibilities are subject to the decision thresholds and ratification requirements under Voting.

Steering Committee. The Steering Committee is accountable for the Coalition as a whole. It develops overall strategy for approval through the Joint Body, oversees Coalition resources and

finances, approves projects and major commitments, takes responsibility for the Coalition's public positions and institutional relationships, and provides final escalation where issues cannot be resolved within or across Chair areas.

Chairs. Chairs are the Coalition's operational leaders. They advise the Steering Committee on strategy, translate agreed priorities into work within and across their areas of responsibility, coordinate available support, sponsor projects where appropriate, and surface issues requiring Coalition-wide decisions. The Steering Committee should actively seek the views of relevant Chairs on matters affecting their areas.

Project Leads. Project Leads are responsible for individual projects. They direct day-to-day work, manage collaborators and resources assigned to the project, maintain its outputs and documentation, and report to the sponsoring Chair as appropriate. Within the scope of an approved project, the Project Lead has primary responsibility for how the work is carried out.

These roles establish accountability and coordination within an open, collaborative research culture. Chairs and Steering Committee members who contribute directly to projects do so as collaborators unless they are exercising a responsibility explicitly assigned to their Coalition role.

5. The Steering Committee

The Steering Committee holds final decision authority for the Coalition, subject to the Joint Body and Chair ratification requirements under Voting. Its substantive responsibilities are described under Responsibilities and Decision Making.

Members of the Steering Committee sit as individuals. The Coalition looks for senior researchers and practitioners who bring resources of some kind with them, whether funding, infrastructure, convening capacity, or institutional reach, and who hold a view of the Coalition as a whole and not only of the projects they work on. No member may hold a seat in an official government capacity.

No person may hold a Steering Committee seat and a Chair position at the same time. A Chair nominated to the Steering Committee resigns all Chair positions on taking the seat.

The current membership of the Committee shall be recorded in a roster the Committee maintains and makes available to all Members.

New Steering Committee members are added by the Steering Committee alone. A seated member nominates, and the nominee takes a seat on the unanimous vote of all seated members. No other body nominates or approves Steering Committee appointments.

A Steering Committee member may resign at any time or be removed by the other seated members in accordance with Voting. A violation of the Code of Conduct is grounds for removal.

The initial Steering Committee at the time of adoption comprises **Stella Biderman, Avijit Ghosh, Irene Solaiman, and Zeerak Talat.**

The Steering Committee may establish non-voting advisory bodies to provide external expertise, review, or conflict-resolution support. Advisory bodies have no governance authority or vote, and their composition and terms are set by the Steering Committee.

6. Chairs

Chairs lead defined areas of Coalition activity in accordance with the responsibilities described above. Each Chair has a primary area of responsibility for each role held. The areas are:

- **Research Chair:** organizes the research proposal and review process, identifies synergies across research projects, makes resource recommendations to the Steering Committee.
- **Strategy and Community Engagement Chair:** Develops and leads the organization's community engagement and programming strategy, designing workshops and initiatives in response to community needs and organizational goals.
- **Partnerships Chair:** responsible for developing and maintaining external partnerships and relationships.
- **Social Media and Public Relations Chair:** responsible for social media and public relations.
- **Fundraising Chair:** responsible for fundraising.
- **Coordination Chair:** responsible for cross-portfolio coordination, including dependencies, shared resources, timelines, and conflicts spanning multiple Chair areas. Unresolved priority conflicts go to the Steering Committee for resolution under the applicable voting rules.

There may be more than one Chair per area of responsibility, and a person may hold more than one Chair role where the Steering Committee determines that they have sufficient capacity. No Chair may simultaneously hold a Steering Committee seat. Each individual Chair has one vote, regardless of the number of Chair roles held.

Any Steering Committee member or Chair may nominate a new Chair to an existing position, with the appointment taking effect on a simple majority vote of the Steering Committee. Any Steering Committee member or Chair may propose a new area of responsibility; adding an area requires an amendment to these bylaws. Appointment to the resulting position follows the ordinary Chair appointment procedure.

Project sponsorship. Sponsorship means that the Chair confirms that the project fits the Coalition's remit, serves as its organizational point of contact, helps the Project Lead identify resources and resolve cross-project issues, and brings requests requiring Steering Committee approval forward. Sponsorship does not give the Chair day-to-day authority over the project.

A Chair may resign at any time or be removed for sustained inactivity in their area of responsibility or conduct that damages the Coalition. A violation of the Code of Conduct is grounds for removal. Thresholds and procedure for removal, and provisions on conflicts of interest, are set out under Voting.

7. Project Leads

A Project Lead is named in the approved proposal or subsequently by the sponsoring Chair and serves for the life of the project, subject to the succession and maintenance provisions under Projects. Project Leads report as required under the project's approval or funding terms and determine with collaborators how contribution and credit are reflected in project outputs, in

accordance with the authorship provisions under Projects.

This is the Coalition's main leadership opportunity for people building a record of service, and time spent as a Project Lead counts when Chairs are selected.

8. General Members

General Membership is open to people who have made, or are actively making, a substantive contribution to a Coalition project, event, community activity, or operation. Membership is confirmed by a Chair on application, with no requirement of institutional affiliation, seniority, or location.

Members take part in projects, propose new ones, stand for Project Lead and Chair roles, and may be nominated to the Steering Committee. Everyone taking part, at every level, is bound by the Coalition's Code of Conduct.

9. Voting

9.1 General Rules

Decisions without a vote. The Steering Committee strives to decide efficiently and by implicit consensus wherever possible. Matters resolved by consensus are recorded in the same way as votes. Decisions for which these bylaws expressly require a vote or ratification must follow that procedure.

Calling a vote. A vote may be called by any Steering Committee member or by the Chair whose area is most closely related to the matter. Any matter is put to a vote when at least two Steering Committee members move to do so. Major decisions listed below must be put to a vote and may not be settled by consensus.

Quorum. Two-thirds of the seated Steering Committee constitutes a quorum for Committee business. A member who casts a vote by message counts toward quorum.

The Joint Body. Where these bylaws require a decision of the Joint Body, the voting body is all seated Steering Committee members and all seated Chairs, counted together as individuals. Each individual has one vote, including a Chair who holds multiple Chair roles. Vacant seats are not counted. Thresholds are calculated on the total number of seated individuals in the Joint Body, not on the number voting. Quorum for the Joint Body is two-thirds of its seated members.

Default rule. Unless these bylaws state otherwise, decisions of the Steering Committee pass by a simple majority of all seated members. Decisions requiring ratification by the Chairs pass by a simple majority of all seated Chairs, counted as individuals. Thresholds are calculated on the total number of eligible seated individuals, not on the number voting, so an abstention or a failure to respond within the stated window has the same effect as a vote against. A tie does not pass. The exclusions for recusals and removal decisions apply to all thresholds and quorums.

How votes are cast. Votes are cast as yea, nay, abstain, or recuse. A vote need not be completed during a meeting. Votes may be cast by message before a meeting, during it, or after it within the stated response window. No decision is actioned before that window closes.

9.2 Notice and Response Windows

No one is required to attend a meeting to vote.

- **Votes taken at or around a meeting:** members have 48 hours after the meeting to cast their vote by message before the matter is actioned. The Chair or member who called the vote notifies all seated members of the relevant voting body that a vote is open.
- **Major decisions:** notice is given to all Steering Committee members and all seated Chairs at least 48 hours before the meeting at which the vote takes place.
- **Votes taken in writing without a meeting:** the request states plainly what is being decided, which threshold applies, and how long members have to respond. The response window is at least five business days for ordinary business and at least ten business days for major decisions.

9.3 Major Decisions

The following must be decided by a vote, with notice as above: approving sponsorships and partnership agreements; accepting funding; setting or changing the Coalition's strategic direction; changing the fiscal host; adopting a material public position on behalf of the Coalition; appointing or removing Steering Committee members or Chairs; amending these bylaws; and pausing or winding down the Coalition. The applicable thresholds are set out below.

9.4 Decisions by Simple Majority

Unless a higher threshold is specified below, decisions pass by a simple majority of all seated Steering Committee members. This includes approving projects and committing resources within an agreed budget; approving sponsorships and partnership agreements; accepting funding that falls within established policy and raises no material question about the Coalition's independence; seating new Chairs in established positions on nomination by any Steering Committee member or Chair; and adopting or amending the Code of Conduct policy.

Branding decisions and endorsements of outside work are decided by the Committee by simple majority and then ratified by the Chairs by simple majority. A Chair who does not respond within the stated window is recorded as abstaining. If the Chairs decline, the question returns to the Committee for revision. An endorsement that also adopts a material public position requires the two-thirds Joint Body approval specified below as well as Chair ratification.

9.5 Decisions by Two Thirds Majority

- **Strategic direction and public positions:** setting or changing the Coalition's strategic direction, and adopting a material public position on behalf of the Coalition, require a two-thirds majority of the Joint Body.
- **Amending these bylaws:** amendment requires a two-thirds majority of the Joint Body, with the proposed text circulated to all Steering Committee members and all seated Chairs in advance of the vote. This includes adding new Chair areas of responsibility.
- **Funding and fiscal host:** accepting funding that falls outside established policy or raises a material question about the Coalition's independence, and changing the fiscal host, require a two-thirds majority of the Joint Body.

- **Removing a Chair:** two-thirds of all seated Steering Committee members must vote for removal, and the other Chairs then ratify by a two-thirds majority. Where no other Chair is seated, the ratification requirement is satisfied by a two-thirds majority of the Joint Body. Grounds are sustained inactivity in the area of responsibility or conduct that damages the Coalition.
- **Code of Conduct violations:** a finding of violation requires a two-thirds majority of the Joint Body and is grounds for removal; the removal itself then runs through the provisions of this section.

9.6 Decisions by Unanimity

Changes to the composition of the Steering Committee require unanimity in both directions. A seated member nominates, and the nominee takes a seat on the unanimous vote of all seated members. A Steering Committee member is removed by unanimous vote of the other seated members.

9.7 Removal and Conflicts of Interest

Removal procedure. In any removal decision, the person under consideration does not vote and is not counted toward the threshold or the quorum. They are told the grounds in writing and given the stated response window to answer before the vote is called.

Conflicts of interest. Anyone with a financial, institutional, personal, or other conflict of interest in a matter under decision discloses it before discussion begins and records their vote as recuse. A recused member is not counted toward the threshold or the quorum for that decision. Recusal ordinarily applies to the decision and vote; the remaining decision-makers may also ask the person to leave the discussion where necessary to manage the conflict.

9.8 Recording and Confidentiality

The outcome of every vote and every consensus decision, and the tally of votes cast, are recorded and made available to all General Members, with confidential funding and personnel details redacted where necessary. How an individual member voted is not recorded or disclosed, except that recusals are recorded by name. Discussion preceding a decision is not attributed to individual members outside the body considering the matter.

General Membership alone carries no vote on removals or on any decision in this section.

10. Projects

10.1 Exploration and Approval

Any Member may explore a project idea, form an interest group, recruit collaborators, or begin preliminary work without formal approval. Formal approval is required for work to be publicly represented as an EvalEval project or to receive Coalition resources.

To become an approved EvalEval project, a proposal must identify its scope, Project Lead, and sponsoring Chair. The sponsoring Chair and one additional Chair review the proposal for fit and unnecessary duplication before it goes to the Steering Committee for approval. If the Chair

ordinarily responsible for the area cannot sponsor the project because of capacity or conflict, another Chair may do so.

Projects may be time-bounded or persistent. Persistent projects should define an ongoing purpose and be reviewed periodically for continuation, maintenance, or closure.

10.2 Resources and Reporting

Project approval and resource allocation are separate decisions. A project may be approved with nothing attached to it and proceed on a volunteer footing. A Project Lead may request funding, compute, or other support through the sponsoring Chair, who makes a recommendation to the Steering Committee. Resource commitments require Steering Committee approval under Voting. Where resources are committed, the Chairs and the Steering Committee are responsible for finding them, whether funding, infrastructure, convening capacity, introductions, or review time.

A project carrying funding or committed resources works under a formal structure: a written scope with milestones, a named and accountable lead, a designated counterpart on the Steering Committee or among the Chairs, and regular reporting on progress, spending, and risks, together with whatever the underlying grant requires. A project carrying neither reports on whatever cadence its sponsoring Chair sets.

10.3 Publication Review and Credit

Every approved EvalEval project must be circulated to all Steering Committee members and its sponsoring Chair before it is made publicly available, with a window of at least seven days for review. Publication separately requires sign-off from at least one Steering Committee member. A sign-off is a written statement that the project is ready to be released, sent to the Project Lead by email or other appropriate means.

Credit on outputs follows contribution and the norms of the venue, and holding office in the Coalition earns no authorship by itself. Running the Coalition is recognized as a contribution that makes EvalEval projects possible, but does not, on its own, qualify a Steering Committee member for authorship on any individual project.

A Steering Committee member or sponsoring Chair who provides substantive feedback, at a minimum on the final draft, is eligible for senior authorship on that project. A Steering Committee member or Chair who wishes to be named must tell the Project Lead in writing before the end of the review window.

10.4 Maintenance and Closure

A project may be moved to maintenance status by its sponsoring Chair when its outlined scope is substantially complete or when its lead's capacity changes. A project in maintenance has no active milestones and no reporting cadence; its artifacts remain available and the sponsoring Chair is responsible for keeping them so. Any continuing grant or funding obligations still apply. A project in maintenance may be reactivated by the sponsoring Chair with a named lead, or closed under the provision below.

A project closes when its previously outlined scope is completed, when its lead steps away and

no one succeeds them, or by decision of the Steering Committee, unless it is moved to maintenance status. Its artifacts remain available afterwards under the Coalition's usual licensing.

11. Speaking for the Coalition

Steering Committee members may represent the Coalition generally. Chairs may represent the Coalition within their areas of responsibility, and Project Leads may represent their approved projects. General Members speak in their individual capacities unless specifically authorized otherwise. Members may say that they belong to the Coalition, but should not imply that the Coalition endorses their own work or their institution's.

Authority to represent the Coalition does not authorize the adoption of new positions or commitments outside the procedures under Voting. The Coalition endorses outside work, positions, letters, and organizations only through the applicable decision and ratification process. Positions the Coalition takes bind no participant or institution, and the positions of participants' institutions do not bind the Coalition.

12. Code of Conduct

All Steering Committee members, Chairs, General Members, and volunteers of the EvalEval Coalition shall conduct themselves with honesty, integrity, and respect for human dignity. The Coalition does not permit harassment, discrimination, or retaliation of any kind, including on the basis of race, color, religion, sex, gender identity, sexual orientation, national origin, age, disability, or any other characteristic protected by law.

The Steering Committee may adopt and amend a Code of Conduct policy to supplement this section. A finding of violation is grounds for removal in accordance with these bylaws; see Voting.

13. Adoption and Amendment

These bylaws take effect upon adoption by the initial Steering Committee. They are amended by a two-thirds majority of the Joint Body in accordance with Voting, with the proposed text circulated to all Steering Committee members and all seated Chairs in advance of the vote. The Steering Committee reviews them periodically. If any provision proves unworkable or conflicts with an obligation of the fiscal host, the rest stand.